

Fixing scp completion in Ubuntu 9.10

Cite as: Martin Paul Eve, "Fixing scp completion in Ubuntu 9.10", *eve.gd: Martin Paul Eve*, December 07, 2009, <https://doi.org/10.59348/za1mv-m3617>.

Currently, owing to a bug, scp in Kubuntu and Ubuntu 9.10 (Karmic Koala) does not allow you to autocomplete remote directories (when you have a passwordless ssh setup, obviously).

While I have submitted a patch for review, this will not be backported into 9.10 and so, those who wish to have this functionality, should follow these steps:

Visit [this bug](#) to read about the problem. Note that this is a problem with bash-completion, not with scp itself.

Download my fix: [bash-completion scp fix for Ubuntu 9.10](#).

Backup your current file:

```
sudo cp /etc/bash_completion.d/ssh ~/ssh_backup
```

Copy the downloaded file to /etc/bash_completion.d/:

```
sudo cp ./ssh /etc/bash_completion.d/
```

Restart your bash session and you should have working scp remote completion! ie. scp remotehost:~/myfi[TAB] will complete to remotehost:/home/you/myfile.txt

Note: I am not responsible for any damage this causes - it is not an official patch and I am unable to provide tech support. If you find problems with the fix, please report them to the official bug posted above which is more likely to get a response.

If anything goes wrong, you can restore the old configuration using:

```
sudo cp ~/ssh_backup /etc/bash_completion.d/ssh
```